



▲ RICHLY TILED WALL AT THE CHINLI KIOSK, TOPKAPI PALACE

Chinli Kiosk, Topkapi Palace

Location Istanbul, Turkey

The Chinli Kiosk is one of the oldest buildings in the Topkapi Palace, the sprawling complex built from 1473 on the orders of Mehmet II, the conqueror of what was Byzantine Constantinople. The administrative and imperial home of the Ottoman sultans, the Chinli Kiosk is a pleasure palace—delicate, airy, and instantly memorable for the glazed tiles with complex geometrical patterns that cover much of the exterior. It is also a typically Persian building, encircled by elegant arcades and polygonal columns. The building has a cruciform plan, with a shallow dome over its center. The overall impact is one of sophistication and worldliness. It would immensely influence subsequent Ottoman architecture.

St. Martin

Location Landshut, Germany

The late-Gothic St. Martin in Bavaria, completed in 1498, is what is known as a hall church—its nave and aisles are the same height. Also, it has no transepts. The effect is the creation of a single, soaring interior, emphasized by plain polygonal columns that line the vertiginous nave and the pencil-thin windows in the aisles that flood light into the building. The stern elegance this creates is reinforced by the sparse rib-vaulting—the ribs are picked out in a somber, flat purple-red. The exterior features are arranged in ordered, repeating patterns below a steep red roof. Its most dramatic feature, dominating the church and town alike, is the slender brick tower over the main entrance, 428 ft (131 m) high.

Tempietto of San Pietro in Montorio

Location Rome, Italy

The importance of Donato Bramante's Tempietto, a small tomb set in the courtyard of the church of San Pietro in Montorio, vastly outweighs its diminutive size. Built in 1502, it is arguably the most influential building of the Renaissance. Its Classicism, combined with a sense of harmony, makes it the first architectural masterpiece of the Renaissance. It is circular, raised on three shallow steps, with 16 Doric columns supporting an entablature over which there is a balconied walkway. From this rises a high drum, with alternating round- and square-headed niches, above which sits the supreme architectural symbol of the Renaissance—a dome (see pp.146–147).

Segovia Cathedral

Location Segovia, Spain

Segovia's vast cathedral, built in 1525–1577, represents a last stand of the Gothic style in Western Europe. Externally, the most notable features are the elaborate finials that rise from almost every point. Flying buttresses spring from many of the finials. The austere bell tower rises 290 ft (88 m) to one side of the main entrance. There is a similar sense of the vertical inside, the most notable feature being complex, decorative fan-vaulting of the nave and aisles. Out of style with the rest of the building, both the bell tower and the crossing are crowned with Baroque domes, added in 1614 and 1630 respectively, each carrying a lantern.

Suleymaniye Mosque

Location Istanbul, Turkey

The Suleymaniye Mosque was built in 1550–1557 on the orders of the greatest Ottoman sultan, Suleiman

the Magnificent. Intended to rival Hagia Sophia (see pp.108–109), it is, in equal measure, a deliberate statement of Ottoman might and Ottoman piety. It is an immense, brooding structure, dominated by a shallow dome, 174 ft (53 m) high. Smaller domes bulge around the building, and there are four thin minarets. The interior, under its glittering, golden dome, consists of a single space flanked on two sides by half-domes and on the other two sides by arches with rows of round-headed windows. The arches of the piers supporting the dome are

